ARGUMENT AGAINST MEASURE V

Measure V would increase the City's sales tax by more than double. The current sales tax consists of a State tax of 7.25% plus a City tax of 0.875%, totaling 8.125%. Measure V would increase the City tax from 0.875% to 1.875% – more than double!

While the ballot question lists several popular public services, it also makes clear that the new revenue is not earmarked for any of those services. Rather, the money goes to the City's general fund, to be spent however the City Council chooses.

A higher sales tax increases the cost of everyday purchases like prepared food, clothing, household items, and school supplies, but especially major purchases like phones, tools, sports equipment and appliances. Families already struggling to make ends meet may be stretched to the brink.

The City faces a temporary budget shortfall, but Measure V proposes a permanent high tax increase. The ballot question says the tax will last "until ended by voters." That means voters would need to collect thousands of signatures to qualify an initiative, then pay for an expensive election campaign, to end or even reduce the tax. That's unlikely to happen.

The City Council has known for decades that its generous "guaranteed benefit" retirement program for city employees was driving the City into debt. Despite repeated calls for reform, however, Council candidates who receive campaign dollars from the employee unions have refused to make a change.

Last year alone, Vacaville owed $39.4 million for city pension benefits. That's more than the annual $28 million that Measure V will generate. So where do you suppose the new tax money will go?

Vacaville families and businesses deserve transparency, accountability, and responsible budgeting – not another discretionary tax disguised as an "essential services" measure.

Vote NO on Measure V.

Solano County Taxpayers Association
s/Michael T Nolan, Preside

s/Timothy Bittle, Vacaville resident
Of Counsel, Howard Jarvis Taxpayers Association